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Reddit plans to unify its search interface as it looks to become a search engine

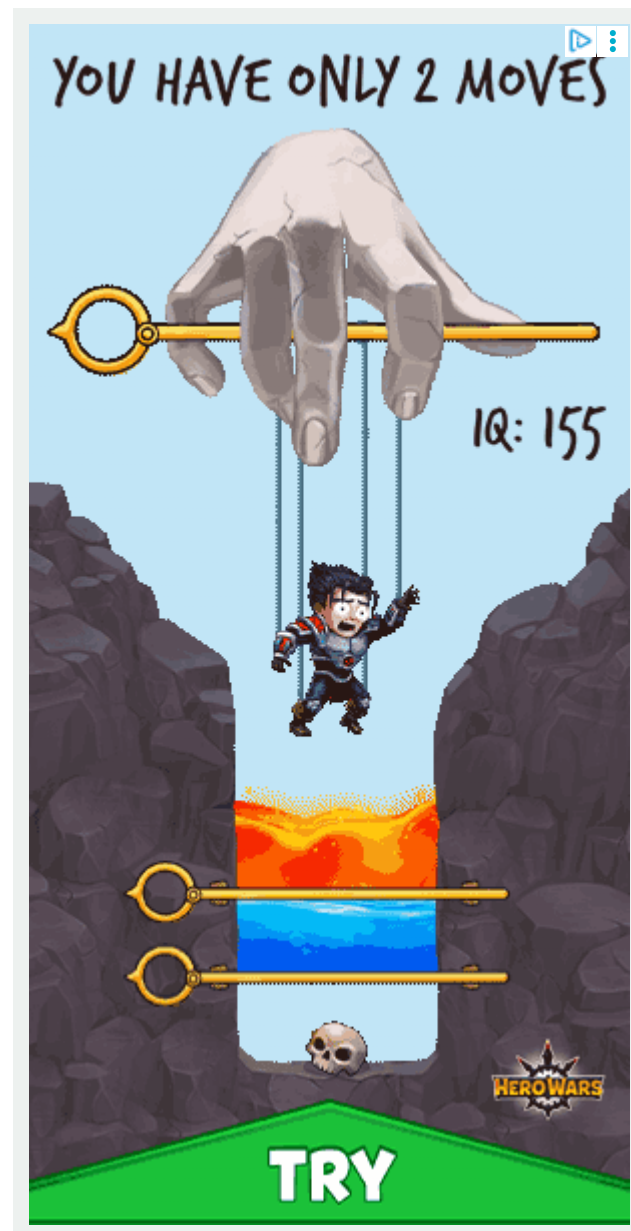
With search today so full of AI slop and sites spamming SEO tricks, it's not unusual for people to append "reddit" to their queries in hopes of finding useful answers to their questions. Google has tried to integrate results from [Reddit in its search interface](#), and taking notice of the trend, Reddit has been experimenting with its [own AI search](#) as well. But the company has loftier ambitions: It wants to become the go-to search engine people use.

Reddit's CEO Steve Huffman said as much during its second-quarter conference call on Thursday: "Reddit is one of the few platforms positioned to become a true search destination. We offer something special, a breadth of conversations and knowledge you can't find anywhere else."

Huffman noted that Reddit's search function has more than 70 million weekly users, and its AI-powered Q&A product, Reddit Answers, is now used by 6 million people.

Reddit Answers is currently available in a dozen countries, and the company plans to expand it globally, as well as give it prominent placement in the site's interface. The company eventually wants to unify the core search function with Reddit Answers, and redesign its app to have the search box be more prominently visible.

"We're unifying those [Reddit search and Reddit Answers] into a single search experience, and



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we're gonna bring that front and center in the app. So, whether you're a new user opening the app for the first time or a returning user opening the app, that search box will be present immediately," Huffman said on the call.

People are increasingly being presented chat-styled search interfaces from products like ChatGPT, Perplexity, and Google's new AI mode. Reddit understandably believes that tapping its rich trove of user posts and comments to help people find answers will help make its search function more useful.

Reddit reported a positive second quarter, with revenue jumping 78% to \$500 million from a year earlier. The company launched [two new ad tools](#), which let marketers use Reddit data to spot trends and leverage comments about brands in their campaigns.

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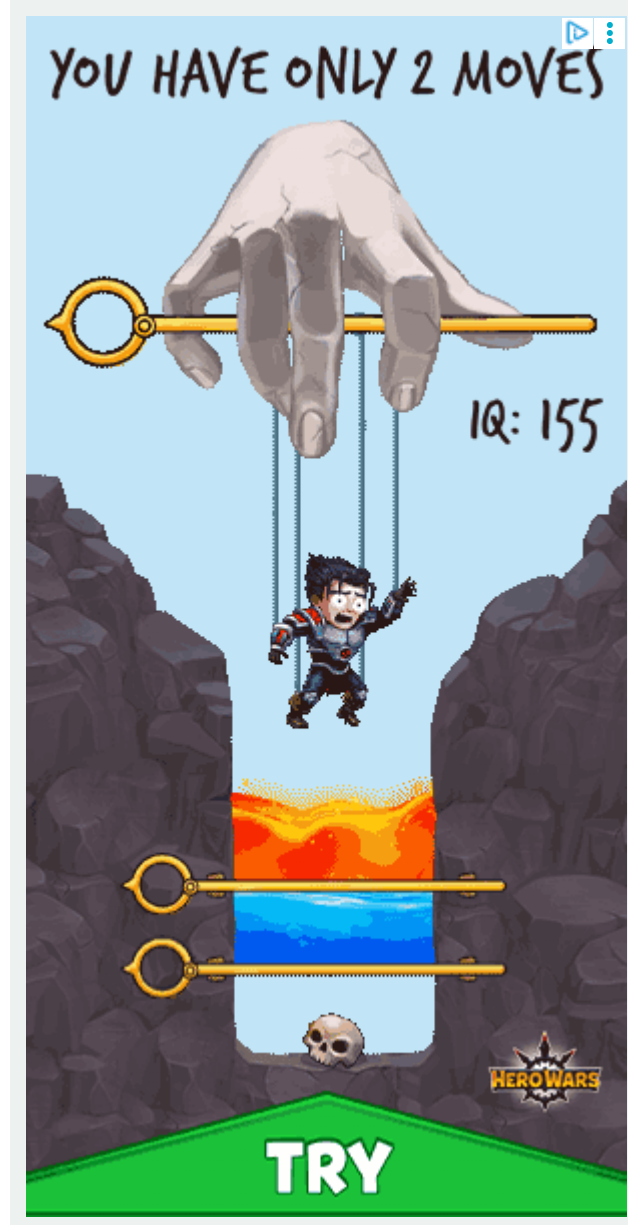


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The Browser Company
launches a \$20 monthly

subscription for its AI-powered browser

Ivan Mehta — 11:26 PM PDT · August 6, 2025

The [Browser Company](#) has launched a Pro subscription plan for Dia, its new web browser that heavily integrates AI features. The plan costs \$20 per month and provides unlimited access to Dia's AI-powered chat and skills features.

The introduction of a paid tier means free users will now face usage limits on AI features. While The Browser Company hasn't specified exact limits, CEO Josh Miller told [The New York Times](#) in July that the browser will remain free for those who use AI features "a few times a week."

IMAGE CREDITS: THE BROWSER COMPANY

IMAGE CREDITS: SCREENSHOT BY TECHCRUNCH

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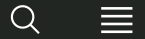
Miller also indicated that the startup plans to offer multiple subscription tiers, ranging from \$5 per

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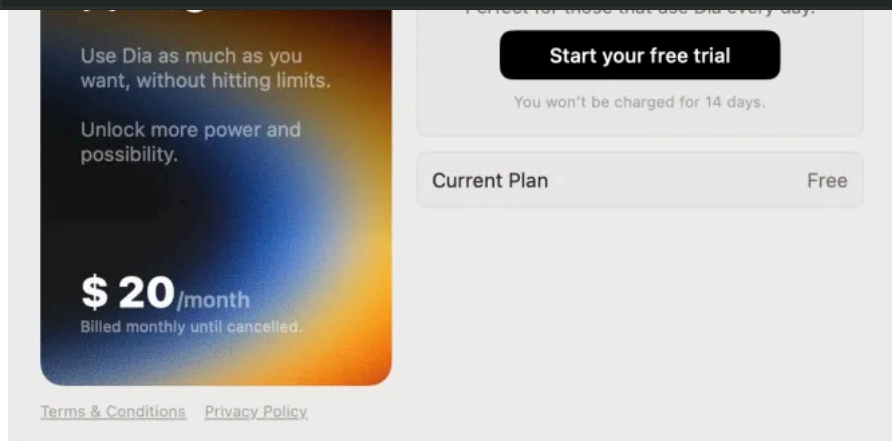
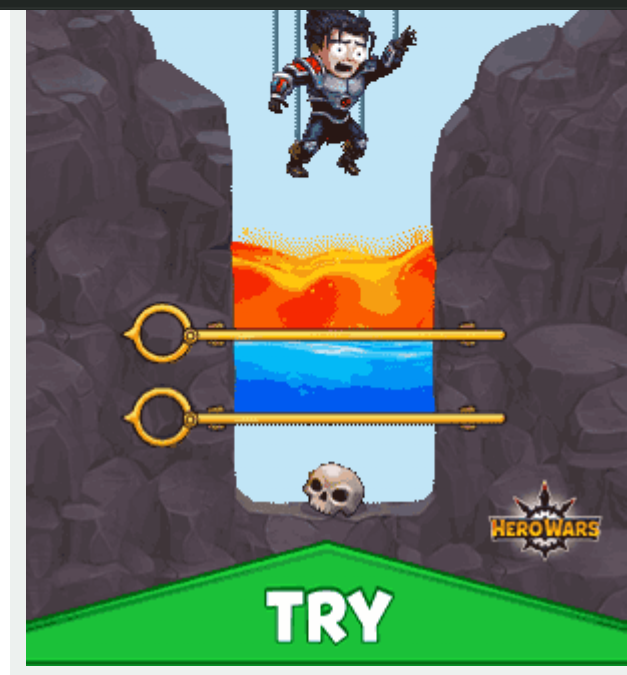


IMAGE CREDITS: SCREENSHOT BY TECHCRUNCH

The Browser Company, which previously made [the Arc browser](#), has raised [\\$128 million](#) from investors, including Pace Capital, Next Play Ventures, and notable tech execs like LinkedIn's Jeff Weiner, Medium's Ev Williams, Figma's Dylan Field, Notion's Akshay Kothari, and GitHub's Jason Warner. This Pro plan represents the company's first revenue-generating subscription service.

The startup faces growing competition when it comes to AI-enhanced browsers. Perplexity's [Comet browser](#) is gaining steam, Opera is also prepping its [Neon browser](#), and incumbents like



[Google](#) and [Microsoft](#) are also integrating their AI assistants into their browsers.



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Ivan Mehta

Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously...

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AI



Google denies AI search features are killing website traffic

Sarah Perez — 12:45 PM PDT · August 6, 2025

Numerous studies indicate that the [shift to AI search features](#) and the use of [AI chatbots](#) are killing traffic to publishers' sites. But Google on Wednesday denied that's the case, at least in aggregate. Instead, the search giant says that total organic click volume from its search engine to websites has been "relatively stable" year-over-year and that average click quality has slightly increased.

"This data is in contrast to third-party reports that inaccurately suggest dramatic declines in

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Tesla shuts down Dojo, the AI training supercomputer that Musk said would be key to full self-driving

Rebecca Bellan

- 55 minutes ago

aggregate traffic — often based on flawed methodologies, isolated examples, or traffic changes that occurred prior to the roll out of AI features in Search,” writes Google VP and Head of Search, Liz Reid, in [a new blog post](#).

Though Google hasn’t shared any specific data to back up its conclusions, even if we assume Google’s claims to be true, this doesn’t necessarily mean that AI isn’t having an impact.

Even Google has to admit this, as Reid acknowledges that “user trends are shifting traffic to different sites, resulting in decreased traffic to some sites and increased traffic to others.”

That word “some” is doing heavy lifting here, as Google doesn’t share data about how many sites are gaining or losing. And while chatbots like ChatGPT have certainly seen traffic increase in recent months, that doesn’t mean online publishers aren’t suffering.



IMAGE CREDITS:GOOGLE

Google has been revamping its search engine for years to answer more questions directly on the search results page, and now does so with AI through its “AI Overviews” that appear at the top of search results. Google also allows users to interact with an AI chatbot for some queries. Yet Google denies that this is significantly reshaping the search landscape. Rather, it points to users shifting their attention to other sites to start their queries.

STARTUPS



High costs and thin margins threatening AI coding startups

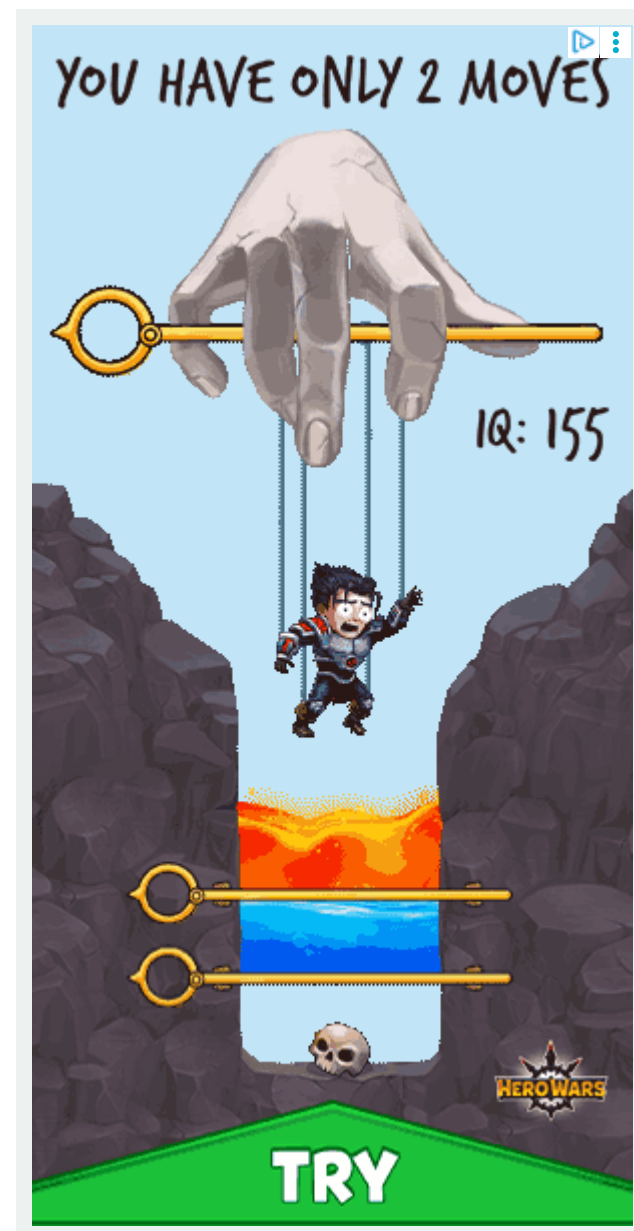
Marina Temkin - 2 hours ago

AI



OpenAI’s GPT-5 is here

Maxwell Zeff - 6 hours ago



Reid explains, “People are increasingly seeking out and clicking on sites with forums, videos, podcasts, and posts where they can hear authentic voices and first-hand perspectives.”

Reading between the lines, it seems like Google.com isn’t necessarily people’s first stop on the web these days. (Google denies this, telling us that Reid’s commentary is only reflective of trends it’s seeing in traffic to sites from Google.)

However, we’ve seen this trend for some time. Back in 2022, a Google exec even said that social sites like TikTok and Instagram [were eating into Google’s core products](#), like Search and Maps.

“In our studies, something like almost 40% of young people, when they’re looking for a place for lunch, they don’t go to Google Maps or Search,” said Google SVP Prabhakar Raghavan, who ran the company’s Knowledge and Information organization at the time (he is now its chief technologist). “They go to TikTok or Instagram,” he noted.

Google has also long been worried that Amazon.com had become people’s first stop for online shopping searches, and Reddit.com had become the first stop for researching topics of interest.

Over many years, the company has tried to come up with compelling features for both consumers and retailers that would attract more users to Google Shopping. These efforts have included [universal shopping carts](#), [local inventory checks](#), [deal finders](#), [shopping from product images on websites](#), and more. It even [made its Shopping listings free](#) for merchants in 2020.

Meanwhile, as users [complained that Google Search quality was declining](#), the search giant was

seeing so much demand for Reddit that it finally added a “Reddit” filter to allow users to narrow down results on relevant search queries. (Now that filter simply reads “forums.”)

So perhaps there’s some truth in Google’s denials — it’s not AI that’s entirely responsible for killing search. Search was already dying.

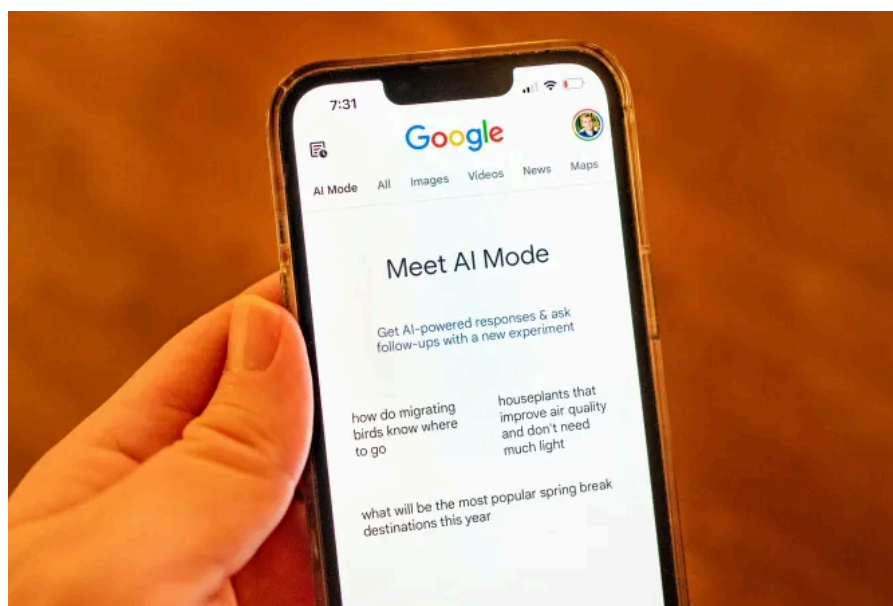


IMAGE CREDITS: SMITH COLLECTION/GADO / GETTY IMAGES

Google’s new blog post also attempts to move the goalposts a bit about what it means for websites receiving Google’s clicks. Now, instead of counting clicks, it wants publishers to think about click quality.

The company says average click quality has increased, and Google is sending “slightly more quality clicks” to websites than a year ago. (Google explains that a quality click is one where users don’t quickly click back — they stay and read.) How much of an increase, though, Google doesn’t say. The company only points out that when people click through on an AI response to the source, they’re more likely to dive deeper, so those clicks are more valuable.

What’s more, Google paints AI as an opportunity for web publishers to gain increased exposure, saying that “with AI Overviews, people are seeing more

links on the page than before,” Reid writes. “More queries and more links mean more opportunities for websites to surface and get clicked.”

But AI, [while a growing referral source](#), isn’t [yet making up the difference](#) in terms of clicks, reports have shown. One recent study from Similarweb indicates that the number of news searches on the web resulting in zero clicks to news websites has grown from 56% (when Google launched AI Overviews in May 2024) to 69% as of May 2025.

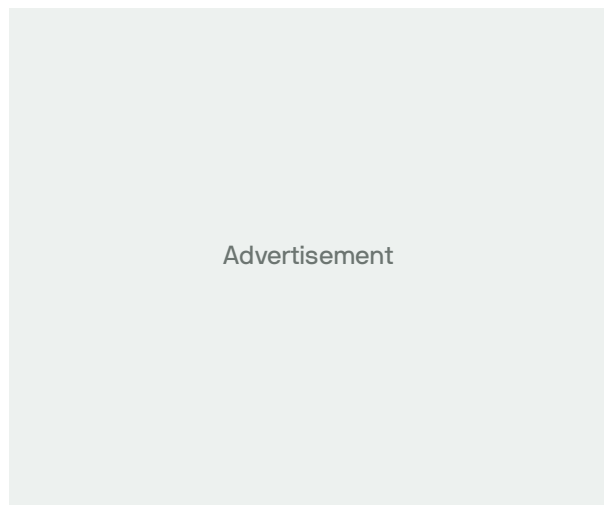
IMAGE CREDITS:SIMILARWEB

Google appears to know this is a trend, too, as it recently launched [a product for publishers](#) that helps them monetize their dwindling traffic in other ways that don’t rely only on advertising, like micropayments or newsletter sign-ups.

The fact that Google is pushing this “AI is not the end of search traffic!” PR now only makes the situation seem more dire. It’s as if Google wants publishers to believe not what their own eyes — and graphs and charts — tell them, but instead take comfort in the fact that Google still sends “billions of clicks to websites” every day, just as the post claims.

Updated after publication with a comment from Google.

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